

GuitarTap Release Notes

Version 1.0.2 · Build 443

What's New Since Build 378

New Features

Update Check

- Guitar Tap now tells you when a newer release is available. On start-up it checks this project's public release list on GitHub and shows a dismissible banner if there is something newer than the version you are running. You can also check on demand from **Check for Updates...** in the App menu (macOS) or the Help menu (Windows / Linux).
- The check is off-switchable, unobtrusive and private. It runs at most once a day, can be turned off entirely in **Settings → About & Help → Check for updates at startup**, and lets you skip a particular release. It never blocks start-up, and it never shows an error if you are offline. No audio, no measurements and no personal data are sent — it reads a public list of releases and nothing else.

Export All / Import

- **Export All** writes every saved measurement to a single file, and **Import** brings a set back in — on the same machine or another one. Useful for backing up a session's work, or moving your measurements to a different device.
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Improvements

Material (Plate & Brace) Results

- The Analysis Results panel now fills in **as you tap**. The Long / Cross / (FLC) rows appear straight away as dashed placeholders and are completed as each phase finishes; the calculated properties appear only once the whole measurement is done. Previously the panel stayed empty until the very end, which gave no sense of progress.
- Peak selection for each material phase now uses the **averaged** spectrum of that phase's taps rather than the last tap alone.

Re-analyze

- **Re-analyze** is now offered for any completed guitar measurement, not only one loaded from a file, and it no longer disables itself after a single press.
- It is a reset: it re-derives the peaks from the spectrum using your current settings, re-classifies the modes from scratch, and returns peak selection to automatic. Custom mode names you have assigned are kept — but the peak carrying one may be deselected, so re-select it to see the label again.
- It is not offered for Plate or Brace measurements, where it does not apply.

Tap Sequence Controls

- **Cancel** now restarts the tap sequence rather than leaving it half-finished, and **New Tap** is available whenever a measurement isn't actively being captured, so you can always start a fresh one.
- The **Taps** (multi-tap comparison) toggle is now enabled and disabled in place instead of appearing and disappearing.
- The **Adjust** button is now labelled **Redo**, which is clearer about what it does.

Status Messages

- The status line stays quiet during the brief warm-up at start-up instead of reporting a state that isn't meaningful yet.
- Plate and brace measurements now show the phase guidance — “Tap the plate along the long axis”, and so on — which was previously being hidden.

Analysis Results Panel

- The **Select All** and **Select None** buttons now show their icons. They were present and working, but drawing blank on macOS.
- Peak **Q factor** is shown to one decimal place, matching the other editions.
- The **Export PDF Report** button is now simply **Export PDF**.

Spectrum Chart

- The **Peak Min** threshold line is now dashed with a right-aligned label, matching the other editions.

Measurements

- The **Measurement Details** pane now shows the same information in the same order across every edition of Guitar Tap.
- Dates and times are displayed consistently throughout the app.
- The display frequency range is now remembered **per measurement type**, so guitar, plate and brace each keep their own view.

Saving

- Saving a measurement now **requires a name**, so every measurement is identifiable at a glance in the list and in exports. The **Save** button stays disabled until you enter one; notes remain optional.

Recording

- **Dump Capture Audio** previously wrote both a WAV for every tap and a continuous recording of the whole session. It now writes only the continuous session recording, which already contains every approved tap in capture order — the per-tap files were redundant.
- With **Dump Capture Audio** on, you can now see and change **where** the WAV files are saved. A folder row appears with **Open Folder / Change...** / **Use Default**; the default is your **Documents** folder plus **GuitarTap** (honouring a redirected or OneDrive Documents location). If you rename, move, or delete that folder, Guitar Tap asks you to fix it (Change Location / Turn Off Saving / Cancel) before the measurement starts, so a capture is never written to a missing folder.

Exporting

- Exported file names are now **consistent across macOS, the Python build, and the web**, and names with accented or non-Latin characters (for example *Ramírez*) are preserved correctly instead of being stripped.

Documentation

- Help now covers Export All, resetting peak selection to automatic, the Cancel-as-restart behaviour, the required measurement name, the settable capture-audio folder, when New Tap is available, and the lead-in a recording needs before the first tap when playing a Plate or Brace measurement from a file.

Bug Fixes

- **The microphone could silently stop delivering audio** — most often because another app took it, or the device reconfigured itself — and Guitar Tap would sit there looking like it was listening while receiving nothing. It now detects this and restarts the input automatically.
- **Status bar:** during a plate or brace measurement the tap count restarted at each phase, the progress bar blinked in and out, and the label could freeze at 0/N. The bar now appears with the first tap and stays for the whole sequence, counting every tap across all phases.
- **Brace measurements** labelled the status “Phase 1/1”; they now read “Tap X/N” like every other measurement.

- **Microphone hot-plugging** was not detected, and switching input devices could crash the app.
- Switching from a material measurement back to a guitar measurement could leave the capture stranded in the previous state.
- **New Tap could get stuck disabled.** If you cancelled the capture-folder prompt — or launched with a chosen folder that was no longer reachable — the app could end up with every tap control disabled and no way to start. New Tap is now available whenever the detector is idle, so you can always begin again.
- **Ring-out (decay time) could be misreported.** It was sampled on too coarse a cadence and timed with the wall clock, so a busy computer could skew the number; the “Good” threshold was also wrong for acoustic and generic guitars. It is now sampled once per audio chunk and timed on the audio clock — staying accurate under load — with the correct thresholds.
- Material peak selection used the last tap rather than the averaged spectrum of the phase.
- Microphone **calibration files** were not reading the reference-SPL / sensitivity-factor precedence the same way as the other editions, which could shift the level.
- **Playing a measurement from a file** did not detect taps the same way a live measurement does. It used a fixed threshold rather than tracking the noise floor, and its warm-up was timed on the clock rather than on the audio, so the warm-up expired before any audio had arrived. File playback now behaves exactly like a live measurement — which also means a recording needs a short lead-in before its first tap (see Help).
- During a plate capture, the identified peaks were not annotated on the chart until the whole measurement finished. They now appear at the completion of each phase (Longitudinal, then Cross, then FLC).



Version 1.0.1 · Build 378

What’s New Since Build 376



Improvements

Spectrum Chart Controls

- Added a **Chart Options** button to the spectrum chart that opens the same reset/options menu as right-clicking the chart.

Measurements List

- The actions button on each measurement row now opens a menu with the same actions as right-click.

Measurement Provenance

- Saved `.guitartap` files now record the **capture sample rate**. On load, the app warns if the current microphone's calibration or sample rate differs from what was recorded. This keeps the format in step with the GuitarTap Apple app, so files remain fully interchangeable.

Documentation

- The Quick-Start Guide has been refreshed.
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Bug Fixes

- Fixed a loaded guitar measurement showing a **blank spectrum** when the app was restarted while the previously loaded measurement was a Plate or Brace (material) measurement.
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Version 1.0 · Build 376

What's New Since Build 375

Improvements

Cross-Platform File Compatibility

- Measurement files (`.guitartap`) written by the Python build now match the iOS/macOS Swift app exactly for the same measurement. Numeric precision, field names, and the encoding of peak mode-label overrides and annotation positions have all been aligned with the Swift format, so files round-trip cleanly in both directions.
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Bug Fixes

- Fixed user-assigned peak **mode-label overrides** being written in a layout the Swift app could not read, which prevented those measurement files

from opening in the iOS/macOS app. Overrides are now written in the shared format; both the new and the previous layouts are still read on import.

- Fixed the minimum-peak-threshold value being saved under a legacy field name, so it is now preserved when a file is opened in the Swift app.
- Aligned saved numeric precision — peak frequencies, magnitudes, Q, thresholds, and material dimensions — with the Swift build so values match exactly across platforms.



Version 1.0 · Build 375

What's New Since Build 368

New Features

Linux AppImage Distribution

- GuitarTap now ships as an **AppImage** for Linux — a single self-contained executable that requires no system package installation. The AppImage bundles Python, Qt, and all dependencies; download, mark executable, and run.

User Manual

- A comprehensive **User Manual** is now available, covering all three measurement modes (Guitar, Plate, Brace), the spectrum chart, saving and exporting measurements, a complete settings reference, a controls reference, and tips and troubleshooting. Eleven chapters plus appendices for keyboard shortcuts and file formats. The manual is published separately as HTML and PDF. The manual can be opened from the Help in the menu bar or from the Settings dialog.
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Improvements

Smaller macOS Bundle

- The macOS bundle is now considerably smaller (about 70 MB, down from previous builds). Download time and disk footprint are correspondingly reduced.

Measurement Detail View

- The detail-pane buttons (Load into View, Export Measurement, Export PDF Report) have been removed. All these actions are still available — and were always available — via the popup menu on a measurement row. The detail pane is now strictly a read-only view of the measurement with a single **Close** button.
- The Edit popup-menu item has been renamed from “Edit...” to **Edit Name & Notes** so the action is explicit about what it edits.
- The “...” ellipsis suffix has been dropped from the Export Measurement / Export Spectrum / Export PDF Report popup-menu items so the wording matches the Swift build’s menu.

Date and Time in the Measurements List

- Each measurement row now shows both the **date and time** of capture rather than time only. The display respects the current locale.
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Bug Fixes

- Fixed a detection-state hang reproducible after capturing a gated measurement: loading a saved plate measurement, lowering the Threshold below the room’s noise floor, then changing measurement type to Generic Guitar would cause a phantom tap to fire, leaving the analyzer stuck with **Pause** enabled and **New Tap** disabled — unrecoverable without restarting the app. The fix is mirrored in the Swift build.
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Version 1.0 · Build 368

What’s New Since Build 263

New Features

Plate and Brace Measurements

- The Plate and Brace measurement modes have been overhauled and now produce correct, repeatable results on both Python and the iOS/macOS Swift app for the same captured audio.
- Each tap phase (Longitudinal, Cross-grain, FLC for plates; Longitudinal for braces) now freezes the spectrum on completion so the result can be reviewed before accepting or redoing.

- FFT processing for plate/brace was aligned bit-for-bit with the Swift implementation — frequency and magnitude readouts now match between platforms for the same input.
- Cross-grain (fC) peak selection now picks the strongest peak rather than the lowest, which avoids re-selecting the longitudinal peak when the two frequency ranges overlap.
- An optional preference makes fC always greater than fL, useful for plates where the two modes are close.
- Plate PDF report generation has been completed: results from all phases are rendered with annotations matching the live view.

Generic Guitar Type

- A new **Generic Guitar** measurement type joins Classical, Flamenco, and Acoustic. Use it for guitars that do not fit cleanly into one of the specific body types, or for initial exploration. Generic uses broad mode-frequency ranges that cover every guitar style.

Multi-Tap Comparison for Guitar Measurements

- When you capture a multi-tap guitar measurement, the Results panel now provides a comparison view showing each individual tap alongside the averaged result. You can switch between the averaged spectrum and per-tap spectra to identify variation across taps.
- PDF export for multi-tap guitar measurements now renders as a two-page report — the averaged spectrum on page 1 and the per-tap comparison on page 2.

Session Recording for Replay

- Each measurement now writes a single WAV file containing the full recorded session, so the actual audio behind a result can be replayed and re-analysed later.

Re-Analyze Button on Loaded Measurements

- Loaded measurements now have a **Re-analyze** button that re-runs the peak-detection algorithm against the stored spectrum using the current settings. Useful for trying a different peak-min threshold or guitar type on a previously-captured measurement without re-tapping.

Magnitude Edge-Detection Trigger

- The tap-trigger has been changed from “FFT peak above threshold” to **magnitude (RMS) edge detection**. This is faster, more responsive, and far less prone to false triggers from spectral leakage. The Threshold slider continues to control the trigger level in all modes (guitar, plate, brace).

Microphone Name on the Results Panel

- The Analysis Results panel now displays the name of the microphone used for the capture. Saved measurements record the microphone name so it appears on subsequent loads and on the PDF report.

Pause / Resume in Guitar Mode

- Pause was previously only available in plate/brace mode. It now works in guitar mode too, letting you freeze the live display, adjust Threshold or Peak Min, and resume without an accidental measurement firing.

Crash Visibility on Windows

- If GuitarTap fails to start on Windows (where there is no console window), a dialog now appears with the error message and the location of the crash log so the failure is no longer silent.
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Improvements

Hysteresis and Max Peaks — Settings Removed

- The Hysteresis and Maximum Peaks settings have been retired. Hysteresis is now hardcoded to a sensible value (3 dB), and Maximum Peaks is “all” — every peak above the Peak-Min threshold is returned. This simplifies the settings panel and removes two knobs that needed tuning to get good results.

Threshold Naming and Coverage

- The “Peak Threshold” setting has been renamed to **Peak Min Threshold** to make clear that it gates the minimum magnitude required for a peak to be reported. The Tap Detection Threshold remains a separate setting that controls the rising-edge tap trigger and is now active in every measurement mode (guitar, plate, and brace).
- The Peak Min slider is automatically disabled when a measurement comparison is being displayed, since the threshold cannot meaningfully apply across multiple saved results.

Audio File Playback

- Erratic or inconsistent results when analysing a WAV file have been fixed — playback timing and FFT synchronisation are now reliable.
- The chart title correctly shows the played filename during and after playback, and resets to “New” when a fresh tap sequence is started (for example by switching measurement type to brace after playback ends).

- Tap count is correctly displayed during file playback.
- The Play File dialog's **Browse** buttons now remember the last directory used per button — opening an audio file returns you to the audio folder, opening a calibration returns you to the calibration folder.
- File reading is more robust and handles stereo input correctly.

Microphone Handling on Windows

- A misbehaving WASAPI shared-mode stream (silently zero-sample input on some built-in microphones) is now detected and the user is informed rather than seeing a flat-line spectrum.
- Microphone hot-plug switching has been reworked: removing and inserting a USB microphone is detected reliably and the audio engine restarts on the right device.
- WASAPI is now the preferred Windows audio host API, avoiding pseudo-streams that delivered all-zero samples.

Spectrum Image and PDF Export

- Exported spectrum images and PDFs now match the live view: same chart title, same mode-line label positions, same dragged-annotation positions, and the captured measurement type, platform, and software version are stamped on the export.
- The calibration profile used for a measurement is now included in the PDF report.
- Annotations that had been hidden in the export are now correctly suppressed; annotations that had been repositioned by dragging now export at their dragged positions.

Saved Measurements

- Double-click a saved measurement to load it; a single click no longer triggers a load (which previously made it easy to load a measurement by accident while trying to select one for comparison).
- The Save / Save As behaviour around loaded measurements has been cleaned up so the Save button stays available in the expected states.
- A peak-comparison view no longer scrolls when a measurement row is selected.

Settings

- The settings layout has been tidied so related controls are grouped together.
- Switching guitar type (for example, Generic to Classical) now reclassifies the displayed peaks automatically rather than requiring a fresh tap sequence.
- Switching across the guitar / material boundary (between guitar and plate / brace) correctly restarts the tap sequence and resets the chart title.

Installation

- Dependency version requirements have been relaxed from exact to minimum versions, reducing installation conflicts when other Python packages share the environment.

Help

- The Help view has been updated to document Play Audio File, Re-analyze, and the new measurement-type workflow.
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Bug Fixes

- Fixed a bug where captured guitar taps were silently discarded as “orphan captures” whenever the measurement type was Acoustic, Classical, or Flamenco. Only Generic Guitar produced results before this fix.
 - Fixed boolean settings (Dump Capture Audio, Show Unknown Modes) reverting to their default state every launch on Windows because QSettings round-trips booleans as strings on that platform.
 - Fixed the chart title not resetting after switching measurement type post file-playback.
 - Fixed the chart title reverting from a played filename back to “New” mid-playback.
 - Fixed several test WAV / icon binary files that had been corrupted in the repository by historical CRLF line-ending normalisation; the corruption is now automatically detected and prevented by `.gitattributes`.
 - Fixed broken Help menu on macOS.
 - Fixed scroll-wheel on macOS causing too-rapid axis updates.
 - Fixed a hang in the audio engine on macOS when stopping the stream during a transient device error.
 - Fixed Save button disappearing in some states.
 - Fixed import error handling — failed imports now report a clear error.
 - Fixed inconsistent measurement-type / guitar-type combination after editing settings.
 - Fixed mode lines being drawn for the wrong guitar type on first run.
 - Fixed quality-colour duplication between the PDF and the live view.
 - Fixed missing tap count display in the toolbar during file playback.
 - Fixed FFT frequency / magnitude values diverging between the Python and Swift implementations for the same input.
 - Fixed spinner width sizing in the toolbar on some platforms.
 - Fixed spurious peak detected in brace measurements.
 - Fixed transition from a multi-tap comparison back to a multi-waveform comparison.
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Version 1.0 · Build 263

What's New Since Build 251

New Features

Play Audio File — Reliability and Accuracy

- Erratic or inconsistent results when analysing from a WAV file have been fixed — playback timing and FFT synchronisation are now much more robust.
 - The FFT processing stack has been aligned with the iOS/macOS Swift version so that frequency and magnitude results now match between platforms.
 - The chart title correctly shows the filename during and after playback, and no longer reverts to the default title.
 - Fixed a bug where the tap count display was missing during file playback.
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Improvements

Crash Visibility on Windows

- Previously, if Guitar Tap failed to start on Windows (where there is no console window), the failure was completely silent. The app now detects startup errors and shows a dialog with the error message and the location of a crash log file, making it possible to diagnose problems without needing a developer build.
- The splash screen is now always dismissed before the main window starts loading, so it can no longer get stuck on screen if startup is slow or fails.

Help

- The Help view has been updated to document the Play Audio File feature.

Installation

- Dependency version requirements have been relaxed to minimum versions rather than exact versions, reducing installation conflicts when other Python packages are present.
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Bug Fixes

- Fixed the chart title reverting after loading a file for playback.
- Fixed missing tap count shown in the toolbar during file playback.
- Fixed erratic FFT results when playing back a WAV file.
- Fixed FFT frequency/magnitude values diverging from the Swift version for the same input.
- Fixed spinner width sizing in the toolbar on some platforms.

Build number is generated automatically from the git commit count.